

which stood in Wall Street, opposite to the present banking house of Brown, Bros. & Co., and job off small lots of governments or stock in the Manhattan Company, and Bank of New York. In 1816, a permanent organization existed, consisting of twenty-eight members. The names of most of the men composing this coterie linger now only in the memory of the old New Yorkers, or are written on the "dull cold marble" which records in the conventional phrase of olden times, the virtues of these men of 'change. Two of them, A. N. Gifford and Warren Lawton, veterans of a hundred campaigns and survivors of fifty years of the sharp vicissitudes of Wall Street, are, or lately were, still wearing out a green old age.

These outside operators have faces strongly marked by the exciting life they lead. Their features often become set into a fixed expression of anxiety.

As early as 1837, the organization had grown to be a power, but a power for evil rather than good, since it stimulated in the community a thirst for speculation. In that year, too, fell the great banking and brokerage firm of J. L. and S. Josepfs, agents of the Rothschilds, and rated at \$5,000,000, involving multitudes in a wide-spread ruin. The successors and assigns of the twenty-eight brokers of 1816, have, indeed, fed on strong food, and waxed exceeding great. They number, in 1870, between ten and eleven hundred, and own, or control wealth which is counted by the ten million. The old sycamore has decayed, and fallen beneath the storm, and they meet no longer under the "greenwood tree," though there is a poetic fitness in such a place of meeting for the tau-rine and ursine herd; but in a marble temple dedicated to Mammon, the God of riches, the ponderous iron doors whereof turn like the Miltonic gates of the celestial city on golden hinges.